to lift above the clouds. While Léa and André talked, Rose—disoriented—felt as if she'd arrived at a house where she'd once lived, but there was no longer a front door and she wasn't sure how to get inside. Then, Léa left, and it was only the two of them.

"Let's walk," he said, steering her toward Unter den Linden. "Was it hard to get permission to come to Berlin?"

"Not too hard. It's in the contract that they give us time off."

"That's good," he said. "Tell me about where you work."

"In a factory manufacturing rangefinders. I lacquer tiny cylinders. There's a daily quota."

He nodded. She looked at his hollow cheeks and bony shoulders. "And you?"

"I'd like to tell you something else." He turned to her. "My father's dead." His expression hardened. "He died in the Moosburg Camp in Bavaria. I don't even know where that is."

"Oh, I'm so sorry." She stopped and took his hand. It was cold. "When did you find out?"

"Last week. He's been dead since Christmas—that's nearly a year ago. Maman wrote to me after receiving his personal items." He squeezed his eyes tight. "You're the first person I've been able to tell."

Her heart twisted as she watched him holding back tears. "What happened?"

"The letter said he was shot trying to escape." André choked up. "I feel terrible. I should have done something. He had to have known—"

"There was nothing you could do." The front door reappeared, she'd found the handle, opened it and was back inside. She touched his gaunt face and he leaned into her hand.

"Thank God you're here," he said, kissing the palm of her hand. "I've missed you."

"Me too."

They stood on the busy Unter den Linden, cars and people swirling all around, but they didn't notice—they were just two lovers with all the time in the world. Rose wished there was something she could say to ease his grief, but she couldn't find the words. She wondered if simply being present, giving him her hand to hold, was enough.

"Come," he said, after a while. "Let's go to the island. It's calmer